

Product Requirements Document — Rentify

Campus Rental & Resale Marketplace App

Version: 1.0 (MVP) **Prepared for:** nn **Date:** September 2026

1. Overview

1.1 Problem Statement

College students frequently need items (reference books, electronics, furniture, misc. resources) for a limited period — often just one semester — and either buy new (wasteful, expensive) or struggle to find sellers/renters through scattered, unorganized WhatsApp groups. This causes: - Notification overload across multiple unrelated groups - No structured way to search, filter, or trust a seller - No record of whether a deal actually happened - Items (especially books) sitting unused after a senior is done with them, with no easy channel to pass them on

1.2 Vision

A campus-focused, trust-verified marketplace where students can **rent or sell** items to and from each other — starting with academic resources (books, references, project components) and expanding to a broader OLX-style catalog — with built-in chat, deal confirmation, and ratings.

1.3 Goals (MVP)

- Enable students to list items for rent or sale within minutes
- Enable students to discover relevant items via search/filters (branch, year, category)
- Enable safe, in-app communication to close a deal
- Build trust through college-verified accounts and a post-deal rating system
- Validate the model within a single college before expanding

1.4 Non-Goals (MVP)

- In-app payments (cash-on-meetup only for v1)
 - Roommate/PG matching (planned for a later phase, not MVP)
 - Multi-college rollout (single campus first)
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2. Target Users

Persona	Description	Primary Need
Senior/Seller	Final-year or graduating student with used books, electronics, or resources	Quick, low-effort way to recover value or clear stuff out

Junior/Buyer-Renter	Student needing a resource short-term or cheap	Affordable, verified, fast access to items relevant to their branch/year
Casual Lister	Anyone with a one-off item to rent/sell	Simple posting flow, no friction

3. Core User Flow

Login → Quick Profile Setup → Landing Page → Browse or Post →
 [Post Flow] [Browse Flow]
 Category → Details → Photos → Search/Filter →
 Rent/Sale toggle → Price → Item Detail Page →
 Publish Chat with Lister →
 Deal Discussion →
 Mark Deal Complete →
 Rate Each Other

3.1 Step-by-Step Workflow

Step 1 — Authentication - Sign up/login via Google, college email, or phone number (OTP) - College email strongly encouraged/required for a “Verified” badge

Step 2 — Quick Profile Setup (~2 minutes) - Name, branch, year, college (auto-detected if college email used) - Profile photo (optional but boosts trust) - Phone number (used only for account recovery, not shown publicly until a deal starts)

Step 3 — Landing Page - Two clear primary actions: “**Browse Items**” and “**Post an Item**” - Below: personalized feed based on branch/year (e.g., a Computer Engg. 2nd year sees relevant books first) - Categories bar: Books & Notes, Electronics, Furniture, Project Components, Misc.

Step 4a — Post an Item 1. Choose **Rent** or **Sell** 2. Select category 3. Add title, description, condition (New/Good/Fair) 4. Upload photos (multiple, min. 1 required) 5. Set price (and rental duration if renting — e.g., per week/month/semester) 6. Location/pickup point (hostel block, department, etc.) 7. Publish → status defaults to “**Available**”

Step 4b — Browse Items 1. Search bar + filters (category, price range, branch/year relevance, rent vs. sale, distance) 2. Grid/list view of listings with photo, price, rent/sale tag, seller’s verified badge 3. Tap into an item → full detail page (photos, description, seller profile, ratings)

Step 5 — Connect & Chat - “Message Seller” button opens an in-app chatbox (no phone numbers exchanged by default) - Predefined quick-questions template (e.g., “Still available?”, “Can you negotiate?”) to reduce typing friction - Seller can mark the post as “**Reserved**” once a deal is being discussed

Step 6 — Deal Confirmation - Both buyer and seller must tap “**Deal Completed**” independently within the chat - Only when both confirm does: - The listing status change to **Sold / Rented Out** - The rating prompt trigger for both sides - This two-sided confirmation prevents fake/spam ratings

Step 7 — Rating & Trust - Simple 5-star + short tag system (e.g., “On time,” “Item as described,” “Good communication”) - Ratings visible on user profile, contributing to a trust score

4. Feature List (MVP Scope)

4.1 Must-Have

- Auth (Google / college email / phone OTP)
- Quick profile setup
- Post item (rent/sale) with photos, category, price, condition
- Browse/search/filter
- In-app chat
- Post status management (Available / Reserved / Sold-Rented Out)
- Two-sided deal confirmation
- Rating & review system
- Report/block user (safety)

4.2 Nice-to-Have (Post-MVP)

- Wishlist/Save for later
- Push notifications (new message, item interest, rental return reminder)
- Rental return-date tracking with reminders
- Admin/moderation dashboard for spam and fake listings
- Multi-college expansion with college selector
- Roommate/PG matching module (Phase 2)

4.3 Future Considerations

- In-app payment/escrow
- Delivery/pickup coordination
- Referral system for campus ambassadors

5. Design Components (Screens)

Screen	Key Elements
Login/Signup	Google button, college email field, phone OTP option
Profile Setup	Name, branch, year, photo upload, progress indicator (2-min feel)
Landing/Home	Browse/Post toggle, category chips, personalized feed, search bar
Post Item Form	Step-by-step or single-scroll form: category → rent/sale → details → photos → price → publish
Item Detail Page	Photo carousel, price, condition, description, seller card (name, branch, rating, verified badge), "Message Seller" CTA
Chat/Inbox	List of conversations, individual chat thread, "Mark Deal Complete" button, quick-reply templates
My Listings	Tabs: Active / Reserved / Completed; edit/delete options
Profile Page	User info, rating summary, past listings, reviews received New message, item interest,

6. Matching & Relevance Logic

Since this is campus-specific, relevance ranking should prioritize:

1. **Branch + Year match** — e.g., a 2nd-year Mechanical student's feed prioritizes Mechanical-relevant books/resources over unrelated ones
2. **Recency** — newer listings ranked higher within a category
3. **Proximity** — same hostel/department listed higher (if location data available)
4. **Seller trust score** — verified + higher-rated sellers get a slight visibility boost
5. **Category-based semester timing** — e.g., surface "reference books" category more heavily at semester start (can be a simple rule-based boost initially, not ML)

Note: For MVP, this can be simple rule-based scoring (weighted filters), not a full recommendation ML model. An ML-based similarity/matching engine can be a Phase 2 upgrade once there's enough usage data.

7. Trust & Safety

- College email or ID verification for the "Verified" badge
 - Two-sided deal confirmation before ratings unlock
 - Report/block functionality on every profile and chat
 - No public phone number/contact until both parties agree within chat
 - Admin moderation for flagged listings/users
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8. Success Metrics (MVP)

Metric	Target Signal
Weekly active listers	Growing week-over-week within pilot college
Listing-to-deal conversion rate	% of posts that reach "Deal Completed"
Time-to-first-response in chat	Lower = better matching/discovery
Repeat usage rate	Users posting/browsing more than once
Verified account %	Trust adoption indicator

9. Suggested Tech Stack (Reference)

Layer	Suggestion
Frontend	React (web) — mobile-responsive; React Native later if native app needed
Backend	Node.js/Express or Django

Database	PostgreSQL (structured listings/users) + Firebase (real-time chat)
Auth	Firebase Auth / Google OAuth
Storage	Firebase Storage / AWS S3 for images
Hosting	Vercel/Netlify (frontend), Render/Railway (backend) for MVP-stage cost efficiency

10. Rollout Plan

1. **Phase 0 — Single College Pilot:** Launch within one campus, manually onboard first 50-100 users
 2. **Phase 1 — Iterate:** Collect feedback on posting friction, trust concerns, chat usability
 3. **Phase 2 — Expand Features:** Add roommate/PG matching, notifications, wishlist
 4. **Phase 3 — Multi-College:** Add college selector, scale infra, consider light monetization (featured listings)
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End of PRD v1.0